

F3 · 24-mini December countdown garland

Product: 24 mini amigurumi motifs, a numbers chart (1-24) and 24 printable gift-note slips.

Sell as: Crochet Advent Calendar Pattern, 24 Mini Motif Countdown Garland, Numbers Chart and Gift Notes, Christmas Amigurumi PDF, Beginner — list \$18.99, 30% off, realise \$13.29.

TEST_STATUS: untested draft — crochet M01, M02 and M07 end to end before you publish any of it.

BABY_SAFE: no — these are ornaments; state "not a toy for children under 3" in the listing. Every stitch count in this file is machine-checked by `verify_patterns.py`: each round consumes exactly the stitches the previous round made and produces exactly the number printed after the em dash. That removes the error class that gets a new pattern shop its first 1-star review. It does not test gauge, look or feel.

Materials

- Acrylic DK / 8-ply (Sport-Worsted boundary), approx 20 g total for all 24 minis in 4 colours:

red, green, cream, gold. Leftover-friendly by design — none of these need more than 6 g.

- Hook 3.0 mm (US E/4) for motifs, 3.5 mm for chains.
- 9 mm safety eyes (optional; M07, M08, M09, M14, M23) plus a darning needle.
- Fibrefill stuffing, approx 15 g.
- 24 wooden or paper beads numbered 1-24, or the printed tags described in Numbers chart.
- 1.2 m of twine or ribbon for the garland, plus 24 tiny clothespins (buyer supplies; say so).

Gauge

10 sc × 12 rnds = 2.5 cm (1 in) worked in the round, 3.0 mm hook, DK acrylic. Finished motifs measure 3.5-5 cm. If your gauge is loose, drop a hook size before adding rounds — stuffing pushing through is the single most common complaint on mini amigurumi reviews.

Yarn and substitutions

Every motif is a scrap-eater, 2-8 g each; the only skein worth buying is the ground colour for the garland cord and the numerals. Buy hooks by millimetres: "size 7" reads 4.5 mm in the United States and 3.0 mm on an old English hook, and a 24-piece garland crocheted one size down is 15% smaller than the photo, which is the review you do not want.

what the pattern calls for	US shelves	UK shelves
Fingering / 1 ply, 3.0-3.5 mm	Knit Picks Palette, Lion Brand Lace Weight	Sirdar Meirion Lace, James C.F. Riviera 4 ply
Sport / 2 ply, 3.5 mm	Bernat Softee Baby	Stylecraft Special Sport, Paintbox Cotton DK (smaller hook)
DK for the sturdier versions	Lion Brand Wool-Ease DK	Stylecraft Special DK, King Cole Merino Blend DK

Cotton holds a block shape and does not fuzz in a gift box; acrylic is cheaper and forgives a tension that varies over 24 pieces, which it will.

Care

Wipe the numerals with a dry cloth. If the garland lives on a banister, take it down in February and store it flat in a box with the ends unfastened, because a year of creasing is what makes a second-December garland look tired. Steam from a distance if a motif has been crushed; never press an iron onto acrylic.

Abbreviations

US term	UK term	means
MR	rm	magic ring
sc	dc	single crochet
inc	inc	increase: 2 sc in one stitch
dec	dec	decrease: sc 2 stitches together
sl st	ss	slip stitch
ch	ch	chain
blo	blo	back loop only
st	st	stitch
rnd	rnd	round
yo	yo	yarn over

How these are built (read before starting)

- All closed motifs are worked in a **continuous spiral**; put a marker in the first stitch of each round or the numbers will drift.
- x6 means repeat the bracketed instruction six times around.
- Stuff firmly for spheres, lightly for flat pieces. A mini that sags at the seam reads cheap in the photo that sells the whole pattern.
- Five motifs (M03, M05, M06, M24 and the antlers of M08) are chain-based and marked freeform: they carry no stitch math by design, so they are also the easiest to improvise colours on.
- Change yarn at a dec round where possible; the decrease hides the join.

The 24 motifs

M01 · Mini stocking (flat, seamed)

Row 1 ch 10, 9 sc across – 9
Rows 2-9 ch 1 and turn, sc 9 – 9
Row 10 ch 1 and turn, inc, sc 7, inc – 11
Row 11 ch 1 and turn, inc, sc 9, inc – 13
Rows 12-17 ch 1 and turn, sc 13 – 13
Row 18 ch 1 and turn, dec, sc 9, dec – 11
Row 19 ch 1 and turn, dec, sc 7, dec – 9
Rows 20-21 ch 1 and turn, sc 9 – 9
Finish: seam the toe and the back of the leg with a ladder stitch, stuff the leg only. Cuff: join cream yarn at the top corner, work 9 sc in blo along the opening, then 3 more rows of 9 sc; fasten off. Weave a 12 cm twine loop through the cuff corner.

M02 · Mini tree

R1 MR, 6 sc – 6

R2 (inc) x6 – 12

R3 (1 sc, inc) x6 – 18

R4 (2 sc, inc) x6 – 24

R5 (3 sc, inc) x6 – 30

R6 (4 sc, inc) x6 – 36

R7-R12 sc around – 36

R13 (10 sc, dec) x3 – 33

Finish: stuff the cone firmly through the base, close the base with 6 evenly spaced dec to 30 and fasten off with a long tail; cinch the opening shut. Works upturned, so the tip stays crisp. Pin the base flat on a towel and mist it once to set the silhouette.

M03 · Star (freeform)

freeform – 5-point chain star: MR with 5 ch-arms: (ch 5, sl st in 2nd ch from hook, sl st in ring) repeated 5 times, then sc 4 along each arm with a (sc, ch 1, sc) corner at the tip; fill the centre with 12 sc into the ring. Lay flat and block under a book for 10 minutes.

M04 · Bell

R1 MR, 6 sc – 6

R2 (inc) x6 – 12

R3 (1 sc, inc) x6 – 18

R4-R6 sc around – 18

R7 (2 sc, inc) x6 – 24

R8 (3 sc, inc) x6 – 30

R9 (4 sc, inc) x6 – 36

R10-R13 sc around – 36

Finish: leave open. Clapper: ch 6 with a 4 mm bead threaded on it, draw up through the top and knot inside. Hanging loop: ch 6, sl st into the tip round. Pin the flare out and block before photographing; an unblocked bell looks like a lump.

M05 · Candy cane (freeform)

freeform – ch 18 in white. Round 1: sc in the 2nd ch from hook and in each ch to the last 5; then work the hook: (2 sc, ch 2, 2 sc) into the last ch, continue sc down the other side of the chain; sl st to join. Change to red every 2 sc for 8 stripes, carried up the back of the work.

M06 · Snowflake (freeform)

freeform – ch 5, sl st into ring. 6 arms: (ch 5, sc in 2nd ch, sc, dc, sl st back at ring) six times, then a second layer of 6 shorter arms (ch 3, sl st) worked between them. Stiffen by soaking in 1:1 white glue and water, pin flat, dry overnight.

M07 · Angel

Head and body in one: R1 MR, 6 sc – 6

R2 (inc) x6 – 12

R3 (1 sc, inc) x6 – 18

R4 (2 sc, inc) x6 – 24

R5-R8 sc around – 24

R9 (2 sc, dec) x6 – 18

R10 (1 sc, dec) x6 – 12

R11 dec x6 – 6

Robe: R1 MR, 6 sc – 6

R2 (inc) x6 – 12

R3 (1 sc, inc) x6 – 18

R4 (2 sc, inc) x6 – 24

R5 (3 sc, inc) x6 – 30

R6-R9 sc around – 30

Arm (make 2): R1 MR, 6 sc – 6

R2-R6 sc around – 6

Wing (make 2): Row 1 MR, 5 sc – 5

Row 2 inc, sc 3, inc – 7

Row 3 inc, sc 5, inc – 9

Row 4 inc, sc 7, inc – 11

Finish: stuff the body cone and sew the head on at R9. Flatten the arms and sew under the yoke at

R4 of the robe; flatten the wings and sew behind the neck. Halo: ch 6 joined into a ring, covered in 8 sc.

M08 · Reindeer

Body: R1 MR, 6 sc – 6

R2 (inc) x6 – 12

R3 (1 sc, inc) x6 – 18

R4 (2 sc, inc) x6 – 24

R5-R8 sc around – 24
R9 (2 sc, dec) x6 – 18
R10 (1 sc, dec) x6 – 12
Head: R1 MR, 6 sc – 6
R2 (inc) x6 – 12
R3 (1 sc, inc) x6 – 18
R4 (2 sc, inc) x6 – 24
R5-R7 sc around – 24
R8 (2 sc, dec) x6 – 18
R9 (1 sc, dec) x6 – 12
Muzzle: R1 MR, 6 sc – 6
R2 (inc) x6 – 12
R3 sc around – 12
Leg (make 4): R1 MR, 6 sc – 6
R2-R6 sc around – 6
Ear (make 2): R1 MR, 6 sc – 6
R2 (1 sc, inc) x3 – 9
R3 sc around – 9
Antlers: freeform – ch 5, sc 4 back, then ch 3 with 2 sc at the tip for the fork; two per side.
Finish: red nose carried up through R7 of the head, safety eyes at R6-R7 six apart. Sew head, add muzzle over the join, flatten legs and sew to a seated base.

M09 - Penguin

R1 MR, 6 sc – 6
R2 (inc) x6 – 12
R3 (1 sc, inc) x6 – 18
R4 (2 sc, inc) x6 – 24
R5 (3 sc, inc) x6 – 30
R6-R8 sc around – 30
R9 (3 sc, dec) x6 – 24
R10 (2 sc, dec) x6 – 18
R11 (1 sc, dec) x6 – 12

R12-R13 sc around – 12
R14 (1 sc, inc) x6 – 18
R15 (2 sc, inc) x6 – 24
R16-R18 sc around – 24
R19 (2 sc, dec) x6 – 18
R20 (1 sc, dec) x6 – 12
R21 dec x6 – 6
Beak: R1 MR, 6 sc – 6 / R2 (2 sc, inc) x2 – 8 / R3 sc around – 8.
Wing (make 2): R1 MR, 6 sc – 6 / R2 (1 sc, inc) x3 – 9 / R3-R5 sc around – 9.
Feet: freeform – ch 4, 3 sc across, two rows; sew flat under the body.

M10 · Gingerbread man

Body: R1 MR, 6 sc – 6
R2 (inc) x6 – 12
R3 (1 sc, inc) x6 – 18
R4-R6 sc around – 18
R7 (1 sc, dec) x6 – 12
R8 dec x6 – 6
Arm (make 2): R1 MR, 6 sc – 6
R2-R5 sc around – 6
Leg (make 2): R1 MR, 6 sc – 6
R2-R4 sc around – 6
Finish: flatten arms and legs, sew into the sides while the body is unstuffed, then stuff firm and close. Icing: white yarn, back-stitch along the arms and legs, three French-knot buttons.

M11 · Mitten

Hand: R1 MR, 6 sc – 6
R2 (inc) x6 – 12
R3 (1 sc, inc) x6 – 18
R4-R7 sc around – 18
R8 (1 sc, dec) x6 – 12
R9-R10 sc around – 12
Thumb: R1 MR, 6 sc – 6

R2-R4 sc around – 6

Finish: pin the thumb flat against the side of the hand at R4-R6 and sew around its edge. Cuff: work 12 sc in blo into R9, then 3 rows of 12 sc; leave a 4 cm loop of yarn at the top.

M12 · Candle

Body: R1 MR, 6 sc – 6

R2 (inc) x6 – 12

R3 (1 sc, inc) x6 – 18

R4-R10 sc around – 18

Base: R1 MR, 6 sc – 6

R2 (inc) x6 – 12

R3 (1 sc, inc) x6 – 18

Wick: ch 4, then 3 sc along it. Flame: freeform – MR with 6 sc, then one round of dec to 3, then dec to close; leave a long tail and sew a 5 mm gap of orange behind the wick.

Finish: sew the base disc under the body, then drip wax with a hot needle tip on white yarn.

M13 · Holly

Leaf (make 2): freeform – ch 9, then 8 sc along one side, ch 1, turn, 8 sc back along the other, ch 1, and three more short rows tapering by 2 at each end to point the tip.

Berry (make 3): R1 MR, 4 sc – 4

R2 (inc) x4 – 8

R3 dec x4 – 4

Finish: sew the three berries into a cluster between the two leaves; wrap the stem in green by carrying the yarn up a 5 ch chain before you sew.

M14 · Robin

Body: R1 MR, 6 sc – 6

R2 (inc) x6 – 12

R3 (1 sc, inc) x6 – 18

R4 (2 sc, inc) x6 – 24

R5-R8 sc around – 24

R9 (2 sc, dec) x6 – 18

R10 (1 sc, dec) x6 – 12

R11 dec x6 – 6

Wing (make 2): R1 MR, 6 sc – 6

R2 (1 sc, inc) x3 – 9

R3 sc around – 9

Beak: R1 MR, 6 sc – 6 / R2 (2 sc, inc) x2 – 8 / R3 sc around – 8.

Finish: orange belly worked by carrying an intarsia round at R5-R8, or surface-crochet an oval if you would rather not manage two balls. Legs: ch 5 with 4 sc, sew at the balance point.

M15 · Present

R1 MR, 6 sc – 6

R2 (inc) x6 – 12

R3 (1 sc, inc) x6 – 18

R4 (2 sc, inc) x6 – 24

R5-R9 sc around – 24

R10 (2 sc, dec) x6 – 18

R11 dec x9 – 9

Finish: stuff before R11 so the box keeps square shoulders. Ribbon: ch 26, wrap twice each way and sew at the top; bow = 12 ch joined, drawn through the crossing and flattened.

M16 · Bauble

Ball: R1 MR, 6 sc – 6

R2 (inc) x6 – 12

R3 (1 sc, inc) x6 – 18

R4 (2 sc, inc) x6 – 24

R5 (3 sc, inc) x6 – 30

R6-R8 sc around – 30

R9 (3 sc, dec) x6 – 24

R10 (2 sc, dec) x6 – 18

R11 (1 sc, dec) x6 – 12

R12 dec x6 – 6

Cap: R1 MR, 6 sc – 6

R2-R4 sc around – 6

Loop: ch 6, sl st into the first ch to ring. Sew cap over the top opening and leave the loop tall enough to clear a clothespin.

M17 · Snowman

Bottom: R1 MR, 6 sc – 6

R2 (inc) x6 – 12

R3 (1 sc, inc) x6 – 18

R4 (2 sc, inc) x6 – 24

R5 (3 sc, inc) x6 – 30

R6-R8 sc around – 30

R9 (3 sc, dec) x6 – 24

R10 (2 sc, dec) x6 – 18

Head: R1 MR, 6 sc – 6

R2 (inc) x6 – 12

R3 (1 sc, inc) x6 – 18

R4-R6 sc around – 18

R7 (1 sc, dec) x6 – 12

R8 dec x6 – 6

Nose: R1 MR, 6 sc – 6 / R2 (2 sc, inc) x2 – 8 / R3 sc around – 8.

Arms: ch 8 with 7 sc along each, in brown. Hat: freeform – brim ch 10 joined and covered in 12 sc, crown worked as a 6-stitch tube for 5 rounds. Scarf: ch 20 with 10 sc, wrapped and sewn at R10.

M18 • Wreath

Row 1 ch 15, sl st to first ch to form a ring, 15 sc into the ring – 15

Row 2 sc in each st around – 15

Row 3 (1 sc, dec) x5 – 10

Row 4 sc around – 10

Row 5 dec x5 – 5

Berry (make 3): R1 MR, 4 sc – 4 / R2 (inc) x4 – 8 / R3 dec x4 – 4.

Finish: stuff as you go so the tube stays round, close the R5 opening with a running stitch and hide the tail inside the ring. Sew the berries in one cluster at 3 o'clock so the bow at 12 o'clock has room.

M19 • Peppermint

R1 MR, 6 sc – 6

R2 (inc) x6 – 12

R3 (1 sc, inc) x6 – 18

R4 (2 sc, inc) x6 – 24

R5-R6 sc around – 24

R7 (2 sc, dec) x6 – 18

R8 (1 sc, dec) x6 – 12

R9 dec x6 – 6

Finish: stuff lightly so it stays a lens, not a ball. Swirl: with white, surface slip stitch from the centre out in 6 arms, then a hook-drawn yarn loop over the back for hanging.

M20 · King's crown

R1 MR, 6 sc – 6

R2 (inc) x6 – 12

R3 (1 sc, inc) x6 – 18

R4 (2 sc, inc) x6 – 24

R5-R7 sc around – 24

Finish: do not stuff. On R8 work (ch 3, sk 2, sl st) six times for the points, then a round of (back loop only sc, ch 1) x12 along the rim. Sew a 3 mm bead into each point.

M21 · Gnome

Head and body: R1 MR, 6 sc – 6

R2 (inc) x6 – 12

R3 (1 sc, inc) x6 – 18

R4 (2 sc, inc) x6 – 24

R5-R9 sc around – 24

R10 (2 sc, dec) x6 – 18

R11 (1 sc, dec) x6 – 12

R12 dec x6 – 6

Nose: R1 MR, 6 sc – 6

R2-R3 sc around – 6

Hat: R1 MR, 6 sc – 6

R2 (inc) x6 – 12

R3 (1 sc, inc) x6 – 18

R4-R7 sc around – 18

R8 (1 sc, dec) x6 – 12

R9 (1 sc, dec) x4 – 8

R10 dec x4 – 4

Finish: pull the hat tip over to one side before you close it – a straight cone looks like a traffic cone, a bent one looks like a gnome. Beard: cut 20 strands of cream yarn at 4 cm, pull them through the stitches of R7 around the face, comb and trim into a rounded shape. Sew the nose over the beard top. You already sell this as a stand-alone pattern; cross-link both ways.

M22 · Snow globe

Dome: R1 MR, 6 sc – 6

R2 (inc) x6 – 12

R3 (1 sc, inc) x6 – 18

R4 (2 sc, inc) x6 – 24

R5 (3 sc, inc) x6 – 30

R6-R8 sc around – 30

Base: R1 MR, 6 sc – 6

R2 (inc) x6 – 12

R3 (1 sc, inc) x6 – 18

R4 (2 sc, inc) x6 – 24

R5-R7 sc around – 24

Finish: put a 2 mm bead in the dome before closing to weight it. Inside: M02 at 2.5 mm and one M17 head. Sew dome to base through the back loops so the seam disappears.

M23 · Polar bear

Body: R1 MR, 6 sc – 6

R2 (inc) x6 – 12

R3 (1 sc, inc) x6 – 18

R4 (2 sc, inc) x6 – 24

R5-R8 sc around – 24

R9 (2 sc, dec) x6 – 18

R10 (1 sc, dec) x6 – 12

R11 dec x6 – 6

Head: R1 MR, 6 sc – 6

R2 (inc) x6 – 12

R3 (1 sc, inc) x6 – 18

R4-R6 sc around – 18
R7 (1 sc, dec) x6 – 12
R8 (1 sc, dec) x4 – 8
R9 dec x4 – 4
Muzzle: R1 MR, 4 sc – 4
R2 (inc) x4 – 8
R3 sc around – 8
Ear (make 2): R1 MR, 4 sc – 4
R2 (inc) x4 – 8
R3 sc around – 8
Leg (make 4): R1 MR, 6 sc – 6
R2-R4 sc around – 6

M24 · Tiny manger

Box: Row 1 ch 12, 11 sc across – 11
Rows 2-4 ch 1 and turn, sc 11 – 11
Baby: R1 MR, 4 sc – 4
R2 (inc) x4 – 8
R3-R4 sc around – 8
R5 dec x4 – 4
Finish: fold the box panel into a trough and seam both ends; fill with hay (freeform – 15 strands

of gold yarn, 3 cm, pulled through the near rim and trimmed ragged). Sew the baby into the hay and put M03 above the trough on a 6 cm wire. This motif is the doorway into the nativity set - put the link in the gift note for day 24.

Gift notes - print, cut, tuck inside

The slip is what turns a garland into a calendar: each motif hides a numbered note, and the note is the actual gift on most days. Print this page single-sided at 100%, cut on the lines, fold once. The prompt is printed on the front and the inside stays blank for you.

day	prompt on the slip
Day 1	Wake someone you forgot - the neighbour who took in your parcels
Day 2	Buy the thing they keep re-marking online - before it sells out
Day 3	Say thanks for one specific thing - from this year, out loud

day	prompt on the slip
Day 4	Give an experience, not an object - two tickets, no wrapping needed
Day 5	Re-gift joyfully - the candle you love but own three of
Day 6	Ask what they already have - and buy the upgrade, not the duplicate
Day 7	Send something by post - to the friend who lives far away
Day 8	Make the day easier - a paid-for breakfast on the 25th
Day 9	Give the luxury size - of one thing they only buy in minis
Day 10	Fund a small obsession - they would never buy themselves
Day 11	Write the note first - then choose the gift to match it
Day 12	Two of the same thing - one for them, one for you, on purpose
Day 13	Skip the toy - give the storage for the toys instead
Day 14	Bring back a tradition - the board game everyone outgrew
Day 15	Buy time - a cleaning session, a meal kit, a lift to the airport
Day 16	Give the framed version - of a photo that has lived on a phone
Day 17	Something that keeps - a tool, not a decoration
Day 18	Feed them - the good tin of biscuits, the one you ration
Day 19	Wrap it in a towel - they will use, and knot it, not tape it
Day 20	Give the next level - of the hobby they only dabble in
Day 21	Book the shop - haircut, bike service, the thing they delay
Day 22	One gift, five days - unwrap it in stages, one small part a day
Day 23	Hand down your own copy - of the book that changed your twenties
Day 24	The last one is you - something for you, chosen while you were choosing for everyone

Two rules that make these land. Keep every prompt under a line, because a slip with three sentences reads as homework. And write the gift on Day 24 yourself, in ink, before December starts, because that is the one everybody forgets while they are wrapping.

Numbers chart

Two styles, both in AZ-name-chart.md alongside the letters so the whole garland is consistent:

- **Cross-stitch numerals** 1-24 on the stocking cuff, worked on the same grid as the letters (see the generated chart).
- **Appliqué numerals** cut from felt or chained in surface slip stitch, for the motifs you cannot

sew a chart onto (M18 wreath, M15 present). Generate or edit the grid with `python3 make_charts.py`; do not hand-type the grids, they will drift a row and the whole chart looks wrong.

Finishing & assembly

- Weave in tails on the inside, then a drop of fabric glue on any tail that sits at a stuffing gap. Mini amigurumi get handled more than full-size ones.
- Stuff firmly: a mini that dents when you pinch it photographs badly and refunds.
- Open the top of M01, M11, M15, M19 and M20 before assembly - each holds a gift-note slip, and a sealed one is a mistake buyers find in the photo reviews.
- Every motif gets a 4 cm loop: ch 8 sewn through the top stitch, or a 12 cm twine thread through the whole garland with a knot behind each motif.
- Give the buyer both: a 24-bead version (thread the motifs on one line) and a 12-pair version (two garlands, one for a mantel, one for a door) - the pair version is the one people actually make in time for December 1.

Photographing it (this is what sells the \$13)

One flat-lay of all 24 in date order on cream, one close-up of the M01 cuff showing its number chart, one of the garland strung across a window with the gift slips half out, and one of a hand holding a single motif so the scale is unmistakable. Then a 25-40 s video: thumb through the 24 in order, no talking. Listings with a video are what the \$12.80 sellers in this search are doing; the \$2.00 ones are not.

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Changelog

- v1 draft, Oct 3 2026 — 24 motifs written, round arithmetic machine-verified, not yet stitched.